Custom Packaging Business, Kathmandu Valley

Feasibility study, audit and business strategy (NPR 5,00,000 budget)

Research cut-off 2026-10-23

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Executive Summary: Custom Packaging Business, Kathmandu Valley (budget NPR 5,00,000)

Research cut-off: **2026-10-23**. All money is in NPR. FX used: NPR 160.15 per 100 INR and NPR 155.08 per USD (NRB selling rates, 12 Oct 2026).

> **Revision v2 (2026-10-23, after audit and strategy work):** see `13_audit_report.md`, `14_business_strategy.md`, `15_strategy_model.xlsx`.
>
> - Audit fixed 4 high-severity model defects (design time double-counted, unrecoverable VAT missing, simple-average AOV, unbenchmarked prices). Corrected v1 Base: contribution margin 20.3%, break-even NPR 1.60 lakh/month before founder pay (6 orders), min cash −NPR 21,949 with founder pay. It is still marginal.
> - **New recommended strategy:** a small-run packaging studio with an offer ladder (Starter Kit stock box + custom sticker → short-run digital → bulk), short runs sourced from Indian digital printers in pooled monthly imports, home office, 3PL delivery at NPR 80, gang-run stickers, and logistics-partner channels. Strategy base: contribution margin 30.9%, operating profit after founder pay +NPR 3.44 lakh, minimum cash +NPR 2.04 lakh. Conservative (same customers as v1): +NPR 1.03 lakh. Stress: solvent. Severe: fails.
> - The verdict is unchanged: **conditional go, staged pilot, no machinery**. The numbers below are v1 and are superseded where they conflict.

Decision (read this first)

CONDITIONAL GO, as a staged pilot. Do not spend the full NPR 5,00,000 up front, and do not buy machinery.

Question	Answer
Feasible within NPR 5,00,000?	Only as a design-and-sourcing business with no powered machinery. A workshop does not fit. A single label cutter costs about NPR 1.84–3.04 lakh before freight and duty (advertised Indian prices), and unverified landed cost pushes it to about NPR 2.3–3.8 lakh.
Model to select	**Model A, design and sourcing agency** (weighted score 3.85/5). Fallback: **Model B, hybrid studio** (3.18/5), only after a pilot gate. Model C, in-house workshop, scores 1.86/5.

Question	Answer
Launch products	Printed corrugated mailer/bakery boxes, branded kraft paper bags, folding cartons (skincare, soap, candle brands), rigid gift boxes (a few high-ticket orders), and stickers/labels as an add-on.
Outsource	All printing, die-cutting, lamination, gluing and rigid-box making. Keep design, prototyping by hand, sampling, quoting, supplier QC, delivery and invoicing in-house.
Machines to buy	**None** at launch. Hand tools only (about NPR 30,000). First machine to consider after the gate is a sticker/label cutter, funded from profit.
Working capital to reserve	NPR 1,85,000, plus NPR 50,000 contingency.
Break-even (Base)	Fixed cost NPR 32,500/month. Break-even sales about **NPR 1.73 lakh/month, or 6 orders/month**, before founder pay. With NPR 15,000/month founder pay: about NPR 2.53 lakh/month, or 9 orders. Operating break-even in **month 7** before founder pay, month 9 after.
Peak cash need	About NPR 4.75 lakh with an unpaid founder (Base), and about NPR 5.38 lakh if founder pay starts in month 7.
Maximum to commit before demand is proven	**NPR 1,50,000** (Config A).

What the numbers say (Base case, 12 months)

- Revenue is NPR 20.97 lakh from 44 new customers and 74 orders. Contribution is NPR 3.94 lakh.
- Gross margin at each product's minimum-viable tier is **24.8%**, and the contribution-margin ratio is **18.8%**. This is thin.
- If the founder takes **no pay**, the Base case stays solvent. The lowest cash is NPR 24,736 in month 8, and ending cash is NPR 57,652.
- If founder pay of NPR 15,000/month starts in month 7, cash runs **negative from month 8** and bottoms at −NPR 37,735. The 5-lakh ceiling is breached.
- Downside case (half the new customers, 40% lower repeat, +10% supplier cost, +30 collection days): **not solvent**, with a cash shortfall of about NPR 1.9–2.8 lakh.
- Upside case (+40% customers, +30% repeat): solvent, minimum cash +NPR 45,995 with founder pay, profit about +NPR 2.1 lakh.
- Stress tests with an unpaid founder: only "repeat purchases 50% lower" stays solvent. Price −10%, supplier cost +10% or +15%, acquisition 50% slower, and 30-day-later payments all breach zero cash. Supplier failure, seasonality and write-offs breach it mildly (−NPR 20–25k).

The business is viable only if the founder can live without a salary for about 9 months, supplier quotes confirm margins near 25% or better, and sales run at or above the Base ramp. The cushion is thin.

What could make it fail

1. Supplier prices come in higher than assumed. Every supplier cost is an assumption because no quotation was obtained.
2. Customers keep using established box makers and printers, or order only 100–250 units.
3. Slow customer acquisition, which is the single biggest sensitivity.
4. Customers pay late while suppliers need money up front.
5. Quality or rework problems with third-party printers.

What must be proven before committing more than NPR 1,50,000

1. **At least 3 written supplier quotations per product** (see `06_supplier_quotation_request.md`) confirming a gross margin of at least 25% at the minimum order sizes.
2. **At least 3 paying customers (with deposits) within 90 days**, and at least NPR 90,000 billed.
3. Confirmation of the VAT, PAN and registration route with a Nepal CA.

Honest limits of this research

- Web research used a US-only search tool and page fetches. No supplier, customer or machine dealer was contacted, and **no quotations were received**.
- Only one competitor's price list (The Box House Nepal) was directly fetched. Other competitor details are search-snippet level.
- No market size or count of Kathmandu businesses could be verified. The prospect database lists segments, not named businesses.
- The skill repository requested (`EdisonChenAl/agent-reach`) could not be cloned because it asked for credentials, so it was not used.
- Subagents were not used. The workstreams were run sequentially in one session.
- Legal items are from secondary sources and must be confirmed with a Nepal CA or lawyer.

Files: see `12_final_investment_recommendation.md` for the full decision memo and `08_financial_model.xlsx` for the model.

Final Investment Recommendation

Research cut-off 2026-10-23. Verdict: **CONDITIONAL GO. Launch a staged pilot (Model A). Do not commit the full NPR 5,00,000, and do not buy machinery, until the Day-90 gate is passed.**

The evidence base is weak. No supplier quotation was obtained, no customer was interviewed, and no market size could be verified. Every number below that drives profit is an assumption (confidence Low) and is flagged as such in the workbook.

> **Revision v2 (2026-10-23):** the verdict stands (CONDITIONAL GO). The recommended *way* to execute is now `14_business_strategy.md`: launch with the T1 Brand Starter Kit and T4 design packages; send short runs to pooled Indian digital printing only after a written duty quote; use the strategy capital plan (set-up NPR 2.15 lakh, operating cash NPR 2.35 lakh, contingency NPR 50,000; no premises deposit until 15 active customers). Strategy base break-even is about NPR 87,000/month of sales (5–6 orders) before founder pay, or about NPR 1.36 lakh with NPR 15,000 founder pay. Stop-loss rules below are unchanged. Audit corrections to v1 numbers are in `13_audit_report.md` §2.

Answers to the 17 decision questions

1. **Enough demand?** Probably yes for a small business, but unproven. Local printed bakery boxes and stock boxes are sold (Atlas, Box House) [Low–Medium], and the plastic-bag ban favours paper bags [Medium]. No count of Valley prospects was verified. The Base case needs about 44 paying customers in 12 months.
2. **Best entry segment?** Skincare, soap, candle and personal-care brands, then bakeries and boutiques (see `04_customer_prospect_database.csv`).
3. **Launch products (3–5)?** Printed corrugated mailer/bakery boxes, branded kraft paper bags, folding cartons, rigid gift boxes (few, high-value), stickers/labels as an add-on.
4. **Best repeat, cost and margin mix?** Folding cartons and rigid boxes have the highest contribution per order (about NPR 5,000–8,000). Bags and bakery boxes bring repeat. Stickers have the weakest outsourced economics under the assumed costs.
5. **Full workshop realistic within NPR 5 lakh? No.** Config C totals NPR 7.5 lakh, and one cutter alone costs 37–61% of the budget before duty.
6. **Exact machines? None** at launch. Hand tools only (about NPR 30,000). After the gate: a sticker/label cutter (advertised ₹1.15–1.9 lakh, about NPR 1.84–3.04 lakh) only if label orders justify it and a written landed quote exists.
7. **Outsource?** All printing, die-cutting, lamination, gluing and rigid-box making.
8. **Minimum capital to launch safely?** NPR 1,50,000 for the pilot (Config A). NPR 5,00,000 for the full plan, with a peak need of about NPR 4.75 lakh (founder unpaid).
9. **Monthly fixed cost?** NPR 32,500, or NPR 47,500 once NPR 15,000 founder pay starts.
10. **Break-even?** About NPR 1.73 lakh/month sales = 6 orders at an average NPR 28,242 (NPR 2.53 lakh = 9 orders with founder pay). About 34 active customers at an 18% monthly reorder rate would carry 6 orders on reorders alone.
11. **When?** Base case: operating break-even in month 7 (before founder pay), month 9 (after).
12. **Cash in the first six months?** Base-case net cash outflow from operations is about NPR 1.87 lakh, plus NPR 2.65 lakh of set-up spend, so about NPR 4.5 lakh of the 5 lakh is committed by month 6 under the full plan.
13. **Strongest advantage?** Small-run, design-included, sample-first service with one accountable contact. This is an inference and has not been customer-tested.
14. **Assumptions that matter most?** Supplier cost (gross margin 24.8%), new-customer ramp, founder pay, collection days.
15. **Verify before buying machinery?** Landed quote including customs and VAT, service availability in Nepal, consumable costs, power needs, and 3 months of label-order data showing demand.
16. **Expand in-house when?** Label/sticker revenue of at least NPR 1,00,000 a month for 3 months running and a landed machine cost recovered within 12–18 months from the outsourced margin

saved (assumption).
17. **Abandon or change when?** See stop-loss rules below.

Recommended launch budget (Config B, NPR 5,00,000)

Line	NPR
Refurbished design laptop	55,000
Design software, 12 months	15,000
Hand tools and finishing kit	30,000
Furniture and storage	15,000
Premises deposit and fit-out	25,000
Supplier samples and prototypes	40,000
Sample-kit stock	20,000
Registration, CA and professional support	20,000
Launch marketing and sales materials	25,000
Website and communication tools	10,000
Delivery setup	10,000
Set-up subtotal	**2,65,000**
Working capital reserve	1,85,000
Contingency	50,000
Total	**5,00,000**

Released in stages: **Stage 1 (Config A), NPR 1,50,000**: software 8,000; hand tools 10,000; samples 25,000; registration 12,000; marketing 12,000; website 5,000; working capital 60,000; contingency 18,000. Assumes the founder already owns a computer and workspace. If not, add the laptop and deposit lines (NPR 80,000) and the Stage 1 total becomes NPR 2,30,000. **Stage 2 (the rest) is released only on a "continue" decision at Day 90.**

If the founder already owns a laptop and workspace, the workbook's "B-own" column moves NPR 80,000 into working capital (NPR 2,65,000).

Quantified conditions for "go" at day 90

- At least 4 paying customers and at least NPR 90,000 billed.
- Contribution of at least NPR 3,000 on each order and blended gross margin of at least 25%.
- Written quotes from at least 2 suppliers per launch product.
- Deposits collected on every order and no overdue balances older than 15 days.
- A Nepal CA's written confirmation of the registration and VAT route.

Stop-loss rules

1. At Day 90: fewer than 2 paying customers, or less than NPR 50,000 billed, or gross margin below 15% → **stop**. Maximum loss about NPR 1.5 lakh or less.
2. After release of Stage 2: if cash falls below NPR 1,00,000 while monthly contribution is below the fixed cost of NPR 32,500 for 2 consecutive months → **freeze all spending and review**.
3. If cash falls below NPR 50,000 (the contingency level) → **stop new commitments** and wind down or seek other income.
4. Never take founder pay until two consecutive months of positive operating profit.

One-page decision memo (to a founder who cannot afford to lose this money)

Recommendation: Start, but only small. Spend at most **NPR 1,50,000** in the first 90 days. Do not buy a machine. Do not rent a workshop.

Why start at all. Local printed packaging for bakeries exists and sells. The plastic-bag ban helps paper. A one-person design-and-sourcing business needs no machinery and its losses are capped if you stop early. In the Base case it breaks even on operations in month 7 and has positive cash if you take no salary.

Why not commit all NPR 5 lakh. Under reasonable assumptions the margin is thin (about 25% gross, about 19% after delivery and rework). Break-even needs about 6 orders a month of about NPR 28,000 each. If customers come at half the pace, or suppliers charge 10% more, the business runs out of cash inside the NPR 5 lakh. Four of nine stress tests drain more than NPR 1 lakh beyond the cash you have even when you take no salary, and the Downside case burns the entire budget.

What I could not verify. Supplier prices, customer demand, the number of businesses you can reach, and Nepal's rules on VAT classification and machinery duty. Everything depends on getting real quotes and real orders.

What to do in the next 14 days. 1. Meet a CA and confirm registration and the VAT route. 2. Build a verified list of 150 prospects and interview 5. 3. Send the RFQ in `06_supplier_quotation_request.md` to 3 suppliers per product. 4. Make samples for 10 prospects and ask for a deposit-backed first order.

Walk away if: quotes cut your gross margin below 25%, or you cannot get 4 paying customers by Day 90. **Scale up only if:** margins hold, customers reorder, and you have been paid on time.

Do not take a salary before month 7 at the earliest, do not give credit to new customers, and do not buy equipment until the label business justifies it in numbers.

This is research analysis, not financial, tax or legal advice. Returns are not guaranteed. Validate with a Nepal CA and lawyer.

Business Strategy: What to Do and How (Kathmandu Valley Custom Packaging)

Date **2026-10-23**. Companion model: `15_strategy_model.xlsx` (all numbers below come from it). Audit basis: `13_audit_report.md`. Evidence grades: **V** fetched page, **S** search snippet or secondary source, **A** assumption.

0. The strategy in one paragraph

Don't try to be a small packaging factory, and don't be a reseller with a markup. Be **Kathmandu's small-run packaging studio**. Small brands should be able to get branded packaging in **days, from 100 pieces, at a fixed published price**. The method is to copy what makes Indian small-run players work (Printo, EzPac, Diva Design), adapted to Nepal: 1. **Sell a ladder of offers.** Start with a cheap stock-box-plus-custom-sticker kit and move customers up to fully printed packaging. 2. **Route each job to the cheapest source.** Indian digital printers, pooled monthly, take short runs. Nepal factories take bulk runs, bags and rigid boxes. 3. **Cut fixed and variable costs to the bone.** Work from a home office, use 3PL delivery at NPR 80, gang-run stickers, and keep a library of standard sizes. 4. **Grow through partners.** Use logistics companies' merchant bases, not cold outreach alone.

Result: in the model's base case, contribution margin rises from 20% to about 31%. Monthly fixed cost falls from NPR 32,500 to NPR 18,000–27,000. The business stays solvent within NPR 5 lakh in the base, conservative and stress cases, and fails only in a severe case (§8).

1. What competitors teach us

Nepal (see `03_competitor_database.csv` and the Competitor_Matrix sheet)

Player	What they do well	Gap we can use
The Box House Nepal (Thimi)	**Published online prices** for stock boxes: pastry NPR 10, 2 lb cake NPR 35, pizza NPR 20–25 (V)	Stock boxes only, with no branding service shown. **We buy their stock and add the brand layer.**
Atlas Packaging (Gairidhara)	Custom printed cake boxes for Valley bakeries (S)	No visible small-run or sample-first offer or pricing
Prime Felt & Agro (Kathmandu)	In-house design team plus manufacturing partner plus private label; sample packs; 24-hour quote promise (V)	Export and wholesale focus. Local small brands are not its core.
Packaging Product (Lazimpat)	"Custom packaging and design services" (S)	No public pricing found
Global / Ace / Modern / Shree Ganapati	Corrugated capacity (S)	Not built for 100-piece jobs. **Use them as bulk (T3) suppliers, not rivals.**
Handmade-paper makers (Mahaguthi, Nepali Paper Products)	Premium Lokta look, free samples (S)	Use them as the premium gifting supplier

Nepal white space: no Valley player was found that combines **low MOQ + design included + transparent prices + fast delivery**. Nepal competitors score 6–11 out of 21 on the Competitor_Matrix. The target position scores 17.

India: the small-business playbook to copy

Lesson	Who	Evidence	How we apply it
Stock box + custom sticker = branded look without dies or plates	Printo "sticker-embellished mailer", ₹33 from 25 pieces	V	Our **T1 Brand Starter Kit**
Fixed SKUs + instant online price remove quoting and sales cost	EzPac live price calculator; Printo per-SKU pricing	V	Published price card plus a simple website calculator

Lesson	Who	Evidence	How we apply it
Digital printing kills the 500–1,000 MOQ	EzPac from 10 pieces; digital short runs of 50–100 have no die	V	T2 short runs via digital, never offset below about 250
“Start with branded labels on plain packaging”; standard sizes; one vendor; off-peak buying (Jan–Mar)	onlineprintout.in small-business guide	V	Standard-size library; off-peak stock buys
No-minimum label press built against the 500-MOQ norm	Diva Design, Ahmedabad	S	Gang-run sticker batching with one local digital printer
Sourcing platform connecting brands to factories	Bizongo	S	Our T3 broker role, for retention only (margin about 9%)
Express tier at a premium	Printo same-day in selected cities	V	Rush fee +25%

Indian price ceiling (landed in Kathmandu, consolidated, unverified duty 15%): a mono carton or mailer from Printo is about **NPR 90/unit**; a rigid box about NPR 629; a logo kraft bag NPR 28–45. A customer who can import from India pays about the same, plus the hassle of doing it. Our short-run prices must stay at or below this ceiling plus a convenience premium.

2. Where the demand is (anchors found in the audit)

- More than 90% of Nepal’s online merchants are in the Kathmandu Valley. Nepal Can Move has 1,000+ merchants; Pathao Commerce signed 600+ merchants in two weeks (Kathmandu Post, 27 Aug 2026, S).
- 1,530 e-commerce firms applied for registration under the E-commerce Act; 345 approved (S).
- About 10,000 online SMEs nationally (self-reported, MIT Solve, S).
- 170,632 establishments in the Valley (2018 Economic Census, all sectors, S).
- Social commerce reportedly grew 30–40% a year over five years (S).

Implication: the densest, most reachable customer pool is the **Valley’s online sellers**. They ship parcels every day, need presentable boxes, and are reachable through a handful of logistics partners. Bakeries and skincare/candle brands remain the second and third segments.

3. What to sell: the offer ladder

From the Offer_Ladder sheet; prices are ex-VAT.

Tier	Offer	Example order	Price	GM	Contribution per order	Role
T1 Brand Starter Kit	Stock box/bag + custom gang-run sticker + tissue; 3–5 days	100 kits	NPR 80/kit + 1,500 setup = **9,500**	**44%**	3,791	**Entry offer.** Low ticket, fast, high margin, frequent reorders
T2 Short-run Custom	Fully printed cartons/mailers, 100–300 pieces, digital (India pooled or local digital)	200 cartons	NPR 140 + 2,000 design = **30,000**	**37%**	9,815	**Profit engine**
T3 Bulk Custom	1,000+ offset from Nepal factories; die kept for reorders	1,000 mailers	NPR 52 + 4,600 setup = **56,600**	13%	5,313	Retention for graduated customers only
T4 Design-only	Packaging and label design, dieline, mock-up	1 package	**8,000**	**85%**	6,440	Cash-positive from day 1, zero inventory

Tier	Offer	Example order	Price	GM	Contribution per order	Role
T5 Subscription	Monthly scheduled delivery from bulk stock	300 units/month	**21,000/month**	30%	5,529	Locks in recurring revenue

Selling motion: win the customer with T1 or T4, move them to T2 once they need fully printed boxes, offer T5 to the top 10%, and use T3 only when volume exceeds about 1,000. **Postpone:** flexible pouches, pharma, and food-contact boxes without written food-grade confirmation.

4. Where to make it: sourcing rules

From the Sourcing_Decision sheet; Nepal costs are assumptions until quoted.

Job	Cheapest route (model)	Rule
Printed carton or mailer, **100–250 pieces**	**India digital, consolidated** (about NPR 90 vs Nepal offset about NPR 106–199 including the die)	Pool all customers' short runs into **one monthly shipment** of about 1,000 units. A single-customer shipment costs NPR 111–153/unit and fails.
Printed carton or mailer, **1,000+**	Nepal factory (NPR 42–47)	Keep the die; offer reorders
Kraft bags	Nepal (NPR 27–36 vs India NPR 45 landed)	Bulky and cheap; don't import
Rigid gift boxes	Nepal (NPR 343–453 vs India NPR 629)	Find the supplier first; India is the backup
Stickers and labels	Local digital printer, **gang-run**	Don't import; don't buy a printer (see §5)

Precondition: before the first import, get a clearing agent's written duty quote for HS 4819 and an Indian supplier invoice that states GST/export treatment. At 30% duty and NPR 15,000 fixed cost per shipment (scenario S2), T2 margins fall but stay positive.

5. Cost-reduction plan (Cost_Levers sheet, NPR per year at base volume)

#	Lever	Annual effect	Evidence
C7	Segment design templates (bakery, skincare, boutique): 3 h → 1 h per order	1,12,000 founder time	A
C1	Short-run cartons from India digital, pooled	85,000	Printo V; Nepal cost A
C6	Voluntary VAT registration (if most customers are VAT-registered businesses)	75,000	A; trade-off below
C4	3PL delivery at NPR 80 instead of own delivery	73,000	Kathmandu Post S
C2	Gang-run stickers (all customers' jobs on shared sheets weekly)	42,000	A
C5	Home office until 15 active customers	32,000 + 25,000 deposit	—
C8	Off-peak stock buying (Jan–Mar)	21,000	Indian guide V
C3	Standard-size die library (4–6 sizes)	13,000	Indian guide V
C9	50% deposit funds the supplier deposit	Working capital	Policy
Total		**about NPR 4.5 lakh + 21,000 cash timing**	

Not to do: buy a label printer. An Epson ColorWorks C4050 plus cutter costs about NPR 5.5 lakh landed (unverified). At NPR 2.1 saved per label and about 8,300 labels a year, payback is about 31 years (Label_Printer_BE sheet). Revisit only above about 15,000 labels a month.

VAT trade-off (C6): registering removes 7.8% cost leakage (scenario S4: profit +NPR 49,000). But it adds 13% to prices for unregistered customers, who are most Instagram sellers. Register voluntarily only if at least half of revenue comes from VAT-registered businesses, or when turnover nears NPR 30 lakh.

6. Revenue-maximisation plan (Revenue_Levers sheet; upside not included in the base case)

#	Lever	Net gain/yr (A)	How
R3	**Logistics-partner channel** (Nepal Can Move, Pathao Commerce merchant bases)	1,72,000	Co-branded “ship-ready packaging” offer to their merchants. 5% commission. Target 1% conversion of about 1,600 merchants.
R7	Referral credit, 5% on both sides	1,00,000	Card in every delivery
R1	Bundle upsell (sticker + tissue + card + bag)	77,000	Default “complete unboxing” bundle on every quote
R9	Fixed-SKU online catalogue + instant prices (own site, Daraz)	57,000	Copy the EzPac/Printo format
R5	Festival and wedding gifting (Dashain-Tihar; Mangsir–Falgun weddings)	55,000	Sell to corporates and event planners 6–8 weeks before
R2	Reorder automation (WhatsApp at 45 and 75 days, saved files)	44,000	From the first order
R4	Design-only packages	39,000	Sell to brands that print elsewhere
R8	Export/handicraft premium packaging (Lokta, private label, the PFA model)	33,000	Pitch Lokta-wrapped premium boxes to exporters
Total upside		**about NPR 5.8 lakh**	Each needs testing; treat as options, not forecast

Pricing architecture: 1. Published price card per SKU and quantity tier (100 / 250 / 500 / 1,000). 2. Setup/die passed through at 1.15×. 3. Design fee credited against the first print order. 4. Sample fee credited against the order. 5. Rush +25%. 6. 5% off for a 6-month subscription. 7. Minimum contribution NPR 3,000 per order. 8. 50% deposit on T2/T3; T1 and T4 paid 100% upfront.

7. How to execute (order of moves)

Ranked by the Priority_Matrix (ICE score):

Rank	Move	When	Done when
1	Get 3 Nepal quotes + 1 Indian digital quote per product; get a written HS 4819 duty quote	Weeks 1–2	Sourcing_Decision refilled with real numbers
2	Launch the T1 Starter Kit with a fixed price card (Box House-type stock + local gang-run stickers)	Weeks 1–4	5 kits sold
3	Standard-size library (4–6 box sizes, 2 bag sizes) + 3 segment design templates	Weeks 2–6	Templates reused on 50% of orders

Rank	Move	When	Done when
4	Reorder automation	From first order	Every customer has reminder dates
5	Design-only package on Instagram and LinkedIn	Week 1	2 sold
6	Gang-run sticker batching agreement with one local digital printer	Weeks 3–6	Unit sticker cost ≤ NPR 4
7	Website with instant price calculator	Month 2	20% of leads quote themselves
8	Festival/wedding gifting campaign	6–8 weeks before peak	3 corporate orders
9	Pitch Nepal Can Move and Pathao Commerce for a merchant co-offer	Weeks 3–8	Partner agreement signed
10	Decide on VAT registration with a CA	Week 1	Written advice
11	First pooled India import (only after #1 confirms landed cost)	Months 2–3	Landed ≤ NPR 95/unit
12	Subscription offer to top customers	Month 4+	2 subscribers
13	Rent premises	After 15 active customers	—
14	Buy machinery	Only if Label_Printer_BE payback ≤ 18 months	—

Capital plan (Capital_Plan sheet, NPR 5,00,000):

Line	NPR
Laptop	55,000
Software	15,000
Hand tools	20,000
Furniture	5,000
Premises deposit	0
Standard stock inventory + sticker media	**40,000**
Sample kits	20,000
Registration incl. e-commerce	20,000
Launch marketing	20,000
Website + price calculator	15,000
3PL setup	5,000
Set-up subtotal	**2,15,000**
Contingency	50,000
Operating cash	2,35,000

Release it in stages, as in `10_90_day_action_plan.md`: **at most NPR 1.5 lakh before the Day-90 gate.**

8. What the model says (Strategy_Scenarios sheet)

Scenario	Customers	Revenue	CM %	Op. profit after founder pay	Min operating cash	Solvent ≤ 5L?
08 v2 Base (old strategy)	44	19.8 lakh	20.3%	−0.78 lakh	−0.22 lakh	No
S0 Strategy base (+50% customers)	66	23.3 lakh	30.9%	**+3.44 lakh**	+2.04 lakh	**Yes**

Scenario	Customers	Revenue	CM %	Op. profit after founder pay	Min operating cash	Solvent ≤ 5L?
S1 Conservative (same customers as old Base)	44	15.6 lakh	30.9%	**+1.03 lakh**	+1.89 lakh	**Yes**
S2 Stress (duty 30%, prices −10–12%, slower reorders)	44	12.9 lakh	21.0%	−1.07 lakh	+0.71 lakh	Yes
S3 Severe (S2 + 30% fewer customers + founder NPR 25k from month 4)	31	9.0 lakh	21.0%	−3.24 lakh	−1.28 lakh	**No**
S4 Base + VAT registered	66	22.6 lakh	34.1%	+3.93 lakh	+2.10 lakh	Yes

Break-even (S0): fixed cost NPR 27,000/month ÷ 30.9% contribution = **about NPR 87,000/month of sales, about 5–6 orders**. With NPR 15,000 founder pay: about NPR 1.36 lakh/month, or 8 orders.

Why the strategy beats the old plan even with the same number of customers (S1): fixed costs are about NPR 1 lakh a year lower, and contribution margin is about 11 points higher. The higher margin comes from the high-margin T1 kits, India-pooled short runs, design packages, and NPR 80 delivery. The lower AOV (NPR 16,600 vs 26,700) is deliberate: smaller tickets close faster and reorder more often.

What would break it: S3. That means demand at 70% of the old plan, Indian duty at 30%, prices pushed down, and the founder drawing NPR 25,000 from month 4. Guard against it with the stop-loss rules in `12_final_investment_recommendation.md`.

9. KPIs (KPI_Targets sheet)

KPI	Day 30	Day 60	Day 90	Trigger
Paying customers (cumulative)	2	6	12	< 4 by Day 90 → stop
Billed revenue (NPR, cumulative)	15,000	60,000	1,30,000	< 50,000 → stop
Blended gross margin	35%	35%	35%	< 25% → change; < 15% → stop
Reorder share	—	15%	25%	< 10% → change offer
Operating cash (NPR)	2.0 lakh	1.7 lakh	1.5 lakh	< 1 lakh → freeze spend

10. Risks specific to this strategy

Risk	Mitigation
Indian import duty or GST higher than assumed; customs delays	Verify before the first shipment. Keep a Nepal digital printer as fallback for T2. Price T2 off the *verified* landed cost.
Stock-box supplier (e.g., Box House) sees our kits as competition	Buy from 2–3 stock suppliers. Our value is the brand layer, design and service.
Partner channel doesn’t convert	Partners are upside (R3), not in the base case. Keep direct outreach.
Low-ticket T1 orders consume founder time	Fixed SKUs, templates, prepayment, and a minimum order of 50 kits
Direct Model-A competitors (PFA, Packaging Product) copy the price card	Speed (3–5-day T1), local sampling, and reorder service build switching costs
Food-contact orders	Written food-grade confirmation from the supplier before any bakery or takeaway order

Decision: still **conditional go**, now with a better offer design. Run the 90-day pilot with the T1/T4 entry offers and quote-verified T2 sourcing. Scale only if the Day-90 gate is met.

Audit Report: Packaging Business Research Pack (files 01–12)

Audit date: **2026-10-23**. Scope: every file in `packaging_business_research/`, the formulas in `08_financial_model.xlsx`, and the evidence behind each claim. Method: re-read every file, recalculated the workbook in LibreOffice, traced each key number to its source, and benchmarked the assumptions against new Nepal and India evidence gathered for this audit.

Bottom line: v1 had **4 high-severity defects**: two formula/logic errors, an unbenchmarked price set, and a missing tax cost. It also had **6 medium** gaps in evidence and compliance. The formula and logic defects are fixed in `08_financial_model.xlsx` **v2**. The evidence gaps are partly closed by new research and are otherwise flagged. The v1 verdict of *conditional go, no machinery, staged pilot* **still stands**. Benchmarking against Indian small-run suppliers shows the v1 *product mix and offer design* left a lot of margin unused. That finding is the basis of the new strategy in `14_business_strategy.md` and `15_strategy_model.xlsx`.

1. Findings

Severity: **H** = changes the decision or key numbers; **M** = material gap; **L** = presentation or consistency.

ID	File	Finding	Sev.	Effect	Status
A1	08, 07	**Founder design time double-counted.** v1 deducted “internal design labour” (NPR 500–9,000 per order, about 16% of revenue) as a *cash* supplier cost. It then also paid the founder a NPR 15,000 salary from month 7. The same person was paid twice, so cash burn was overstated and the margin understated.	H	Gross margin understated by about 7 percentage points.	**Fixed v2:** toggle `design_cash` (default 0). Design time is covered by founder pay.
A2	08, 09	**Unrecoverable VAT missing.** An unregistered firm cannot reclaim the 13% VAT on supplier bills. v1 treated supplier costs as VAT-free.	H	Supplier cost +7.8% (60% of spend VAT-billed, an assumption).	**Fixed v2:** `vat_reg` and `vat_share` inputs. VAT leakage applied in the engine and in Break_Even.
A3	08	**Simple-average AOV and margin.** v1 averaged the six products equally, so rigid boxes (NPR 42k orders, 5% of real demand) moved AOV as much as kraft bags.	H	AOV overstated (NPR 28,242 → 26,719).	**Fixed v2:** mix-weighted (bags 25%, cartons 20%, mailers 20%, bakery 20%, stickers 10%, rigid 5%; the weights are assumptions).

ID	File	Finding	Sev.	Effect	Status
A4	07, 02	**Selling prices never benchmarked.** Indian small-run suppliers list printed mono cartons at ₹33 (NPR 53) from 10 pieces, printed mailers at ₹30–33, and logo kraft bags at ₹8.5–15 per piece at 500 (Printo, TradeIndia). v1 priced folding cartons at NPR 150 per unit at 100 pieces. After an estimated landed cost of about NPR 90 (unverified duty), v1's short-run carton prices are about 1.5–2× the Indian landed benchmark. The NPR 9,000 die and plate charge makes local offset uneconomic below about 250 units.	H	v1's short-run offer was likely uncompetitive. A cheaper sourcing route was missed.	**Addressed:** `15_strategy_model.xlsx` Sourcing_Decision and the new offer ladder. Needs quotes.
A5	08	**Break-even ignored VAT leakage** after the v2 change (internal review): the contribution ratio showed 25.6% while the engine actually delivered 20.3%.	M	Break-even understated.	**Fixed:** formula now applies the leakage multiplier.
A6	08	**Year-2 jump.** "15% growth" is applied to the month-12 run-rate × 12, so Year-2 revenue is 2.4× Year 1. The label understates the jump.	M	Three-year view looks better than it should.	Flagged. Treat Years 2–3 as illustrative only.
A7	09	**E-commerce Act 2025 missing.** Businesses selling via Facebook, Instagram, TikTok or WhatsApp must register. Fines are up to NPR 2,00,000 (Kathmandu Post, Jul 2025). 1,530 applied and 345 were approved by Aug 2026.	M	Compliance gap for an Instagram-led seller.	**Added** to the 09 checklist (below).

ID	File	Finding	Sev.	Effect	Status
A8	02, 04	**Market sizing had no anchor.** New data: 170,632 establishments in the Valley (2018 Economic Census, all sectors). About 10,000 online SMEs nationally (self-reported, MIT Solve). Nepal Can Move has 1,000+ merchants; Pathao Commerce signed 600+ in two weeks. More than 90% of online merchants are in the Valley (Kathmandu Post, Aug 2026).	M	TAM and SAM are still estimates, but now have anchors.	Partly closed (see 14 §2).
A9	03	**Competitor list thin; two direct rivals missed.** Prime Felt & Agro (Kathmandu; in-house design plus manufacturing partner plus private label; self-described "largest custom packaging wholesaler") and Packaging Product (Lazimpat; "custom packaging and design services") both run Model A. Chandrama Packaging and Infinity Print Nepal were also missed.	M	v1 understated direct competition for Model A.	**Added** to 03.
A10	05, 08	**Machinery list had cutters but no colour label printer.** Epson ColorWorks C4050 is listed at ₹1,52,500 (about NPR 2.44 lakh, about NPR 3.19 lakh landed, unverified).	M	Option missing.	**Added.** Break-even analysis says do not buy (payback is decades at pilot volume).
A11	08	Delivery assumed NPR 400–800 per order and own transport NPR 3,500/month. Third-party logistics in Kathmandu now charge NPR 70–80 per delivery (Kathmandu Post, Aug 2026).	M	Variable cost overstated.	Used in the strategy model. 08 left as is (conservative).

ID	File	Finding	Sev.	Effect	Status
A12	08, 10, 02	Funnel inconsistency: the Assumptions sheet says “~60 contacts/mo × ~10% × 30–40%”. Files 02 and 10 say about 80 contacts/month × 15%.	L	Confusing.	Flagged; 10’s numbers govern.
A13	04	Prospect database has segments only, with no named businesses.	L	Unchanged.	Partner and channel prospects added (see 14). Named list remains a week-1 task.
A14	02, 12	Customs: v1 said the duty was “not found”. The FY 2083/84 budget cut customs slabs from 11 to 7 and lowered rates on 273 items (Himalayan Times). The HS 4819 rate is still not confirmed.	L	Still unverified.	Flagged; a clearing-agent quote is required.
A15	08	Fractional customers in the downside cases (multiplier 0.5) are acceptable for expected values, but they are not whole orders.	L	None.	Noted.

Checks that **passed**: budget reconciles to NPR 5,00,000; Config C correctly exceeds the ceiling; cash identity holds in every engine; no formula errors after recalculation; stress tests run independently (a v1 late-binding bug pointing every sheet at the last engine was fixed before the v1 commit).

2. Effect of the fixes on the v1 Base case (12 months)

Metric	v1	v2 (fixed)	Why
AOV	NPR 28,242	NPR 26,719	Mix-weighted (A3)
Gross margin used	24.8%	31.6% before VAT leakage	Design time no longer double-counted (A1)
Contribution margin	18.8%	**20.3%**	A1 partly offset by VAT leakage (A2)
Revenue	20.97 lakh	19.84 lakh	AOV change
Contribution	3.94 lakh	4.02 lakh	
Op. profit after founder pay	−0.86 lakh	−0.78 lakh	
Minimum cash (founder paid from M7)	−37,735	**−21,949**	Still breaches zero
Break-even sales (before founder pay)	1.73 lakh/mo	1.60 lakh/mo (6 orders)	
Break-even sales (with founder pay)	2.53 lakh/mo	2.34 lakh/mo (9 orders)	
Operating break-even month	7 / 9	7 / 9	unchanged

Conclusion of the audit: the v1 plan *as designed* (sell custom-printed packaging at mid-size MOQs through local factories) is still marginal. It is cash-negative if the founder draws a salary, and it fails in

the downside and in 8 of 9 stress tests. The fixes did not change that. What changes the picture is **how** the business sells and sources (see 14 and 15).

3. Compliance addition (to `09_legal_and_compliance_checklist.md`)

#	Requirement	Authority	Detail	Status	Source
15	E-commerce registration	Dept. of Commerce, Supplies and Consumer Protection	E-commerce Act 2025: online sellers, including those on Facebook, Instagram, TikTok or WhatsApp, must register. Fines are up to NPR 2,00,000 per the July 2025 report; unlisted platforms face NPR 5,000–20,000 per the Aug 2026 report.	✔ (news)	https://kathmandupost.com/money/2025/07/20/unregistered-online-sellers-now-illegal-in-nepal-under-new-e-commerce-law
16	VAT threshold watch	IRD	The strategy base case reaches NPR 23 lakh in year 1, below the NPR 30 lakh services/mixed threshold. Year 2 will cross it. Decide early with a CA whether to register voluntarily (see 14 §6).	✔ (secondary)	udhamsathi.com

4. What remains unverified (unchanged priority)

1. Any written supplier quotation (Nepal or India).
2. The HS 4819 duty rate and India GST/export treatment on small consignments.
3. Customer willingness to pay. No interviews have been done.
4. Named prospect list.
5. Registration route and VAT classification (CA meeting).

Complete Market Research: Custom Packaging, Kathmandu Valley

Research cut-off **2026-10-23**. Evidence labels: **[V]** verified from a fetched source, **[S]** search snippet or secondary source, **[A]** analyst assumption, **[U]** unverified or not found. Confidence is High / Medium / Low, as defined in the brief.

1. What this study could and could not establish

Established	Not established
NRB exchange rates [S, High]. VAT thresholds and rate from a secondary legal guide [S, Medium]. A plastic-bag ban exists [S, Medium]. Price points for stock boxes from The Box House Nepal [V, Medium]. About 14 competitor or supplier candidates, with only one site fetched in full [mixed]. Indian asking prices for cutters and plotters [S, Low].	Any local quotation from a printer or packaging maker. Kathmandu sticker/label printers, rigid-box specialists and paper-bag printing factories (searches found none, which may reflect the search tool). Counts of Valley businesses by segment. Customer interviews. Nepal duty and VAT on machinery. A national or Valley packaging market size (IndexBox teasers hide all numbers).

Everything that drives profit (supplier costs, selling prices, order size, reorder rate, funnel) is therefore **[A] Low confidence** and sits in the Assumptions and Product_Pricing sheets of the workbook so it can be replaced one cell at a time.

2. Product categories (12): demand, outsourcing and viability

Capital judgement is for a NPR 5 lakh budget. “Outsource” means a Nepal or Indian factory does the production.

#	Category	Demand evidence	Buyers	Typical order (assumed)	Make or outsource	Startup viable?	Main risks
1	Kraft/custom paper bags	Plastic-bag ban favours paper [S]; India is the main supplier of paper bags to Nepal [S]	Boutiques, bakeries, gift shops	250–1,000	Outsource	**Yes** (MOQ tier 500)	Thin margin, price competition from imports
2	Folding cartons	Skincare/soap/candle brands need retail boxes [A, no local evidence]	D2C brands, startups	250–1,000	Outsource (offset + die-cut)	**Yes** (die fee charged to customer)	Die costs, MOQ at factory, colour consistency
3	Corrugated shipping/mailer boxes	Box House and others sell them [V/S]	E-commerce, brands	250–1,000	Outsource	**Yes**	Stock-box price anchors (NPR 10–35)
4	Rigid gift boxes	No Kathmandu specialist found [S]; Indian supplier says Nepal is a major market [S]	Gifting, jewellery, cosmetics	50–250	Outsource (possibly India)	**Yes**, few high-value orders	Import lead time, duty, finishing quality
5	Stickers, labels, barcode labels	No local specialist found [S]	All segments	500–5,000	Outsource first; **first in-house candidate**	Marginal at small quantities under assumed costs	Competes with small digital shops

#	Category	Demand evidence	Buyers	Typical order (assumed)	Make or outsource	Startup viable?	Main risks
6	Food/bakery/takeaway boxes	Atlas supplies printed cake boxes to Valley bakeries [S]; Box House sells stock boxes [V]	Bakeries, cafés	250–1,000	Outsource	**Yes**, but price-sensitive	Food-grade proof, stock-box competition
7	E-commerce packaging	Nepal Can Packaging lists courier bags [S]	Online sellers	100–500	Outsource	Partly	Low order value
8	Garment/jewellery/cosmetic/handicraft packaging	Plausible [A]	Boutiques, exporters	100–500	Outsource	Yes (bags, boxes, tags)	Fragmented buyers
9	Tea/coffee/spice packaging	Plausible [A]	Local food brands	500–5,000	Outsource	Limited	Pouch MOQs, food rules
10	Promotional / corporate / event	Seasonal [A]	Agencies, corporates	100–1,000	Outsource	Yes, seasonal	Deadlines, credit
11	Flexible pouches / stand-up	Industrial printers exist (Chandika Print Pack) [S]	FMCG	5,000+	Not for this startup	**No**	High MOQ, machinery, plastics rules
12	Premium candle/soap/skincare packaging	Plausible [A]	Craft and D2C brands	100–500	Outsource	**Best fit**	Small ticket, design-heavy

Process separation: paper bags, folding cartons, corrugated, rigid boxes, labels and flexible pouches use different machinery (bag-making machines, offset presses and die-cutters, corrugators and flexo/slotters, board wrapping and pasting, label presses and cutters, laminators and pouch machines). No one machine makes them all. A cutting plotter can cut labels and prototypes. It does not make a printed carton.

3. Customer segments

No named prospects were verified. Segment priorities, from `04_customer_prospect_database.csv`:

Priority	Segment	Why
1	Skincare, soap, candle and personal-care brands	Design-led, repeat, tolerates higher price, small MOQ is a pain point [A, to test]
2	Bakeries and cake shops	Frequent reorders; local printed-box supply exists (Atlas) so competition is real
3	Boutiques and jewellery	Bags and gift boxes reorder quarterly
4	Corporate gifting and event planners	Large but seasonal, deadline-heavy
5	E-commerce sellers, cafés	High volume of leads, low order value
Postpone	Pharma and medical	Regulatory burden

4. Customer pain points (hypotheses to test, not facts)

Large MOQs, high small-batch prices, limited customisation, poor print consistency, no structural design, no prototypes before bulk orders, long lead times, and the burden of coordinating design, print, finish and delivery. **No interview or public review evidence was found.** Test with 5 interviews in week 1 using these questions: what do you buy, from whom, minimum quantity, price per piece, lead time, last bad experience, would you pay for design and samples.

5. Market sizing (illustrative; TAM and SAM inputs are unsourced)

Formula: annual relevant spend = qualified prospects × annual packaging spend per prospect.

	Low	Base	High
Qualified reachable prospects in the Valley **[A, U]**	600	1,200	2,000
Annual relevant spend per prospect (NPR) **[A]**	40,000	70,000	1,20,000
TAM (NPR)	2.4 crore	8.4 crore	24 crore
Share servable with the chosen products and MOQs **[A]**	25%	30%	35%
SAM (NPR)	60 lakh	2.52 crore	8.4 crore
SOM, 12 months (model output)	8.8 lakh	21.0 lakh	32.9 lakh
SOM as % of SAM	14.6%	8.3%	3.9%

TAM and SAM are only as good as the prospect-count and spend assumptions and should not be quoted as market facts. The meaningful check is that the Base SOM requires about 44 paying customers in 12 months, about 8% of the Base SAM. That is demanding in the low-SAM case and plausible in the base case. Validating the prospect count in week 1 is a go/no-go input.

Funnel (Base, assumption): about 80 contacts a month → about 15% qualified → about half request a quote → part convert to a first paid order, giving about 3.7 new customers a month on average. Over 12 months that needs roughly 900 contacts and so a verified prospect list of that size.

6. Competitive landscape

See `03_competitor_database.csv` (14 candidates; only The Box House Nepal was fetched in full; **fewer than 15 verified competitors**). Observations:

- **Local box makers** (Box House in Bhaktapur, Atlas in Gairidhara, Global Packaging in Mahalaxmi, Shree Ganapati in Jadibuti) compete on corrugated, bakery and pizza boxes. Box House shows retail stock prices of NPR 10–35 per box, which anchor customer price expectations for plain boxes.
- **Industrial printers** (Chandika Print Pack) serve large FMCG clients, not small brands.
- **General job printers** (API Printing Press) do cards, flex and stationery.
- **Handmade-paper exporters** (Nepali Paper Products, Mahaguthi, Shubham Handicrafts, Himalayan Paper Works) cover gift bags and boxes with a handcrafted look.
- **Indian suppliers** (Step Design Printways, S. R. Art Printers) quote for Nepal and compete on rigid boxes and stickers.
- No Kathmandu rigid-box specialist, labels specialist or paper-bag print factory was found. This may be a real gap or a search-tool gap.

Where a new entrant can compete (ranked by customer value, competition, difficulty, margin): 1. Small minimum quantities with a paper sample before print (high value, medium competition, medium difficulty). 2. One-stop design plus procurement (high value, low-medium competition). 3. Custom dimensions with structural design (high value, medium competition). 4. Transparent, itemised quotations (medium value, low difficulty). 5. Recurring supply plans (medium value, builds retention). Fast delivery and low price are not recommended. They depend on suppliers and on capital the startup does not have.

Positioning statement: *“We make your branded packaging easy to order in small runs: design in your size, a paper sample before you pay for print, one clear quote, and delivery to your door.”*

7. Business models compared

Weighted scores from the workbook (`Model_Comparison` sheet; 15 criteria, weights sum to 100, scores 1–5 are analyst judgements):

Model	Capital	Machinery	Weighted score
A. Design and sourcing agency	NPR 2.65 lakh set-up + reserves	None	**3.85**
B. Hybrid design + light conversion	Adds a label/sticker cutter, NPR 1.84–3.8 lakh (advertised to landed estimate)	One machine	3.18
C. In-house workshop	Several machines plus stock and labour; breaches the NPR 5 lakh ceiling with a safe reserve	Many	1.86

A wins on capital, product range, break-even and downside risk. It loses on production control. B adds control over short runs and prototyping, but the machine's advertised cost alone is 37–61% of the budget. C is rejected: Config C in the workbook totals NPR 7.5 lakh.

What to keep in-house: design, hand-made white mock-ups, quoting, supplier QC, delivery and invoicing. **What to outsource:** printing, die-cutting, lamination, gluing, rigid-box making.

8. Machinery (Part 6 summary)

All figures are **advertised Indian prices (INR) from search snippets, not quotations, converted at NPR 160.15 per 100 INR** [Low confidence]; landed cost uses a **25% placeholder uplift, not a researched rate**.

Item	Advertised	NPR (converted)	Est. landed (+25%)
Cutting plotter (Roland GS2-24)	₹1,19,000	1,90,579	2,38,224
Cutting plotter (Radium)	₹1,27,000	2,03,391	2,54,239
Sticker half-cutter	₹1,15,000	1,84,173	2,30,216
Servo label cutter	₹1,90,000	3,04,285	3,80,356
Sticker cutting machine (C Press)	₹1,50,000	2,40,225	3,00,281
Digital half-cutter (C Press)	₹4,50,000	7,20,675	9,00,844
Used Epson T3130n 24" printer	₹95,000	1,52,143	1,90,179

Missing: Nepal customs duty and VAT, local dealer quotes, power specs, warranty and service terms. **Do not buy until these exist.**

Configurations (workbook `Capital_Allocation`):

	A: validation	B: recommended	C: higher capability
Set-up spend	72,000	2,65,000	5,15,000
Working capital	60,000	1,85,000	1,85,000
Contingency	18,000	50,000	50,000
Total	**1,50,000**	**5,00,000**	**7,50,000 (exceeds ceiling by 2,50,000)**

9. Pricing and unit economics

Full table in `07_product_pricing_model.csv`. All supplier costs and prices are **assumptions pending RFQ**. Minimum-viable quantity is the smallest tier with contribution of at least NPR 3,000 per order.

Product	Minimum viable tier	Revenue at that tier	Gross margin	Contribution
Kraft paper bag	500	23,875	23%	4,597

Product	Minimum viable tier	Revenue at that tier	Gross margin	Contribution
Folding carton	100 (die and design fees charged)	28,350	21%	4,940
Printed corrugated mailer	250	29,850	25%	6,222
Sticker/label 50 mm	5,000	20,575	34%	6,206
Rigid gift box	50	42,050	22%	7,989
Bakery/takeaway box	500	24,750	24%	4,919

Under these assumptions, outsourced stickers lose money below about 5,000 pieces. That is the one result that supports buying a cutter later, if real quotes confirm it.

Pricing architecture: unit price by quantity tier; separate setup/die charge at 1.15× the supplier's charge; design fee on custom structures; paper sample fee credited on order; 50% deposit; minimum contribution of NPR 3,000 per order; delivery charged separately below an order value; rush +20–30%; VAT shown separately.

10. Financial results (Base, 12 months)

Metric	Value
Revenue	NPR 20,96,661
Contribution	NPR 3,93,963 (18.8% of revenue)
Fixed opex	NPR 32,500/month (rent 8,000; utilities 3,000; software 2,000; marketing 10,000; transport 3,500; accounting 3,000; misc. 3,000)
Break-even sales/month	NPR 1,72,964 before founder pay (6 orders); NPR 2,52,794 with NPR 15,000 founder pay (9 orders)
Operating break-even	Month 7 before founder pay; month 9 after
Lowest cash, founder unpaid	+NPR 24,736 (month 8); ending +NPR 57,652
Lowest cash, founder paid from month 7	−NPR 37,735 (month 11)
Payback of set-up spend	Set-up spend (NPR 2.65 lakh) is not recovered within 12 months. At the month-12 run-rate (NPR 35,637/month, founder unpaid) it would take about 7.4 more months

Scenario	12-mo revenue	Operating profit after founder pay	Minimum cash (founder paid / unpaid)	Solvent within NPR 5L?
Downside	8.78 lakh	−3.81 lakh	−2.84 lakh / −1.94 lakh	**No**
Base	20.97 lakh	−0.86 lakh	−0.38 lakh / +0.25 lakh	No / **Yes**
Upside	32.94 lakh	+2.13 lakh	+0.46 lakh / +0.64 lakh	Yes

Stress tests (founder unpaid; every one holds back margin or cash): price −10% → min cash −1.21 lakh; supplier +10% → −1.00 lakh; acquisition 50% slower → −0.49 lakh; materials +15% → −1.79 lakh; payments 30 days later → −1.08 lakh; supplier failure → −0.21 lakh; repeat 50% lower → +0.16 lakh (solvent); seasonal concentration → −0.25 lakh; write-off and repair → −0.20 lakh.

Largest drivers: supplier-cost level (gross margin), new-customer ramp, and founder pay. Year 2–3 extrapolations in the workbook are illustrative only.

11. Top risks and mitigation

Risk	Prob.	Impact	Early warning	Mitigation	Residual
Supplier quotes higher than assumed	High	High	RFQ gross margin < 25%	Get 3 quotes per item; use only viable items	Medium

Risk	Prob.	Impact	Early warning	Mitigation	Residual
Slow customer acquisition	High	High	< 3 quote requests/week by week 6	Weekly outreach target; focus on one segment	Medium
Customers stay with established box makers	Medium	High	Lost-quote reasons	Differentiate on small run + sample + design	Medium
Late payment	Medium	High	Deposit not paid	50% deposit; no credit before two on-time payments	Low
Quality or rework	Medium	Medium	Defect rate > 5%	Sign-off proofs, inspect before delivery	Medium
Price war on plain boxes	High	Medium	Quotes at stock-box prices	Avoid commodity boxes	Medium
Single-supplier failure	Medium	Medium	Missed deadlines	Two suppliers per category	Low
Food-contact compliance	Low	High	Customer asks	Written food-grade confirmation	Low
Seasonality (Dashain/Tihar)	Medium	Medium	Order mix	Pre-book supplier capacity	Medium
Founder cash needs	High	High	Cash < NPR 50,000	No founder pay until profitable	Medium

Maximum capital before demand is validated: NPR 1,50,000. Stop-loss rules are in `10_90_day_action_plan.md`.

12. Source list

See `11_sources_and_evidence_register.csv`.

First 90 Days: Pilot Plan (Model A)

Pilot budget cap: NPR 1,50,000 (Config A). Spend beyond this only after the Day-90 gate. Targets are tied to the Base case in `08_financial_model.xlsx` (new customers 0 / 1 / 2 in months 1–3, billed about NPR 90k in months 2–3). The founder is the responsible person for every task unless stated.

Prospect-list protocol (days 1–7)

Build a list of **150 or more** businesses from Google Maps, Instagram and Facebook shops, using public information only. Record: name, segment, area, public contact channel, the packaging they use today (photo evidence), and a priority score (see `04_customer_prospect_database.csv`). Mark “contacted” only after contact has actually happened. The base funnel assumed is about 80 contacts a month, about 15% qualified, about half asking for a quote, and a part of those converting.

Weekly plan

Week	Focus	Tasks	Target (measurable)	Budget (NPR)
1	Discovery	Meet CA. Build the prospect list. 5 customer interviews (bakery, skincare, boutique). Test hypotheses on MOQ, price and lead time.	150 prospects listed; 5 interviews	5,000
2	Supplier verification	Send the RFQ (`06_...md`) to at least 3 suppliers per product. Visit 3–5 workshops. Request samples.	12 quotes requested; 6 received	8,000
3	Pricing and samples	Load real quotes into the model. Set the price list and minimum order rule. Make 3 sample packs.	Gross margin ≥ 25% at MOQ tiers confirmed	15,000
4	Soft launch	Register and obtain PAN (if CA confirms). Set up Instagram, WhatsApp Business and a one-page catalogue. First 40 outreach messages.	40 contacts; 5 quote requests	15,000
5–6	Outreach	25 contacts a week. Hand over sample kits to the best 10 prospects. Quote within 24 hours.	50 contacts; 8 quotes; **first paid order with 50% deposit**	15,000
7–8	Fulfil and learn	Produce the first orders through suppliers with QC checks. Document lead times and defects. Ask for referrals and photos.	2 paid orders; on-time delivery ≥ 90%; zero unresolved quality complaints	10,000
9–10	Expand	Outreach 25 a week. Offer reorders. Start the referral offer (5% credit on the referrer’s next order).	3 paying customers cumulative; billed ≥ NPR 60,000	12,000
11–12	Scale test	Test one corporate-gifting lead. Test recurring supply plans.	4 paying customers; billed ≥ NPR 90,000; collections ≥ the 50% deposits	12,000

Week	Focus	Tasks	Target (measurable)	Budget (NPR)
13	**Gate review**	Compute contribution per order, conversion, cash. Decide continue, change or stop.	See gate below	3,000

Total planned pilot spend: about NPR 95,000 on weekly items, plus the NPR 72,000 Config A set-up lines, which are mostly consumed in the first weeks. Keep the total at or under NPR 1,50,000 including the working-capital reserve of NPR 60,000.

Acquisition tactics

- **Pitch (small brands):** “Branded packaging in your own size and logo, from 100 pieces, with a free paper sample before you pay for print. One person handles design, print and delivery.”
- **Instagram/WhatsApp opener:** “Hi [name], I’m [founder]. I help [bakeries/skincare brands] get branded boxes from small runs. Can I send a sample of a [box type] sized for [their product]?”
- **Email:** Use the same text. Add 2 photos of samples and a price range table.
- **Sample kit:** 3 small samples (bag, carton, sticker) plus a one-page price sheet. Cost about NPR 800–1,200 per kit.
- **Referral:** 5% credit on the next order for both sides.
- **Retention:** Calendar a reorder reminder at 60 and 90 days. Hold the die and artwork file so reorders take one message.
- **Minimum order and deposit policy:** 50% deposit. Orders with contribution below NPR 3,000 are re-quoted at the next quantity or refused.
- **Customer acquisition cost (assumption):** about NPR 10,000/month marketing + about NPR 12,000/month of the founder’s sampling effort ÷ about 3 new customers = about NPR 7,000 per customer. At a contribution of about NPR 5,300 per order, each customer needs about 1.3 orders to repay acquisition. (Low confidence.)

Day-90 gate: continue, change or stop

Result at day 90	Decision
≥ 4 paying customers, billed ≥ NPR 90,000, contribution/order ≥ NPR 3,000, quotes confirm gross margin ≥ 25%, collections on time	**Continue.** Release the rest of the budget up to NPR 5,00,000. Founder pay may start only when monthly operating profit is positive for 2 months.
2–3 paying customers, or margins 15–25%	**Change.** Narrow to the best segment (likely skincare/candle/soap brands), raise prices or minimums, change suppliers, re-test for 60 days. Cap further spend at NPR 50,000.
< 2 paying customers, or billed < NPR 50,000, or gross margin < 15%	**Stop.** Do not buy anything more. Recover stock and samples. Total loss capped at about NPR 1.5 lakh or less.

Stop-loss rules during the pilot

- Pause all spending if, for 3 consecutive weeks from week 5, there are no new quote requests.
- Pause if two orders in a row are below the minimum contribution.
- Do not extend credit before a customer has paid on time twice.
- Total spend never exceeds NPR 1,50,000 before the gate.

Legal, Tax and Compliance Checklist (Nepal)

Research cut-off 2026-10-23. **Status key:** ✔ = supported by a source fetched or surfaced in this research (secondary, still confirm). ⚠ = from general knowledge, **not verified in this session**. Confirm every item with a Nepal CA or lawyer before acting. Authority homepages are listed for convenience and were not fetched.

#	Requirement	Authority	Detail	Est. cost	Status	Source / next step
1	Business form: sole proprietorship vs private limited company	Office of the Company Registrar (OCR) / Department of Industry or local authority	Sole proprietorship is the cheapest start. A private company gives limited liability but costs more to run.	Not verified	⚠	https://ocr.gov.np (confirm with CA)
2	Business/firm registration	Department of Industry or municipality, depending on size and type	Registration route depends on capital and activity (cottage vs small industry vs trading/service).	Not verified	⚠	Ask CA which route fits a design-and-sourcing firm with no machinery
3	PAN	Inland Revenue Department (IRD)	PAN is required before VAT registration.	Free (agent/CA fees apply)	✔ (secondary)	https://udhamsathi.com/blog/vat-registration-nepal; https://ird.gov.np
4	VAT registration	IRD	Mandatory above NPR 50 lakh annual turnover for goods, or NPR 30 lakh for services/mixed. Turnover is measured by the higher of sales or purchases over 12 months. Registration is due within 30 days of crossing the threshold. Standard rate is 13%. A design-plus-goods business may count as “mixed” (NPR 30 lakh), which the Base case (NPR 20.97 lakh) nears. Voluntary registration may be possible, but the source says presumptive-tax taxpayers cannot register voluntarily.	Free	✔ (secondary)	https://udhamsathi.com/blog/vat-registration-nepal (cites VAT Act 2052, Finance Act 2081, VAT Rules 2053 and 26th/28th Amendments). **Confirm classification (goods vs mixed) with CA.**

#	Requirement	Authority	Detail	Est. cost	Status	Source / next step
5	Invoicing and bookkeeping	IRD	Tax invoices, purchase/sales books and returns once VAT-registered.	Accounting budgeted at NPR 3,000/month (assumption)	⚠	ird.gov.np
6	Income tax / presumptive tax	IRD	Small businesses may fall under presumptive tax. Rates not verified here.	Unknown	⚠	Ask CA
7	Municipality business permit, signage, tenancy	Ward/municipality office	Needed if a visible premises is used. Home-based use may need permission.	Unknown	⚠	Check the local ward office
8	Labour obligations if staff are hired	Labour office	Contracts, minimum wage, social security fund. Not needed while the founder works alone.	Unknown	⚠	Ask CA before first hire
9	Plastic bag restriction	Ministry of Forests and Environment / municipalities	A ban on plastic bags below 40 microns under the Environment Protection Act 2019 (s.15) was reported as in force, with fines up to NPR 3,00,000. Enforcement has been weak. This favours paper bags. Confirm current status.	n/a	✔ (news)	https://thehimalayantimes.com/nepal/ban-on-plastic-bags-below-40-micron-comes-into-effect-nationwide
10	Food-contact packaging (bakery/takeaway boxes)	Dept. of Food Technology and Quality Control (DFTQC) / Nepal Bureau of Standards and Metrology	Obtain supplier confirmation of food-grade board, inks and coatings. Required standards not verified here.	Unknown	⚠	https://dftqc.gov.np; https://nbsm.gov.np. **Do not launch food-contact lines without written supplier confirmation.**
11	Pharma / medical packaging	Dept. of Drug Administration	High regulatory burden. **Postponed** in this plan.	n/a	⚠	Not targeted
12	Machinery import (if ever bought)	Dept. of Customs	HS classification, duty and VAT not found for Nepal. Do not assume a rate.	Unknown	⚠	https://customs.gov.np; get a clearing agent's written quote

#	Requirement	Authority	Detail	Est. cost	Status	Source / next step
13	Intellectual property on customer artwork and logos	Contract	Obtain written confirmation that the customer owns or may use the logo. Keep proofs and signed approvals.	NPR 0	⚠	Use the terms below
14	Contracts, deposits, rejected orders	Contract	See template terms below.	NPR 0	⚠	Have a lawyer review once

15 | E-commerce registration (added v2) | Dept. of Commerce, Supplies and Consumer Protection | E-commerce Act 2025: sellers on Facebook, Instagram, TikTok or WhatsApp must register. Fines up to NPR 2,00,000 (Jul 2025 report). | Not verified | ✔ (news) | https://kathmandupost.com/money/2025/07/20/unregistered-online-sellers-now-illegal-in-nepal-under-new-e-commerce-law |
16 | Import of short-run packaging from India (added v2) | Dept. of Customs | HS 4819 duty not confirmed. The FY 2083/84 budget cut customs slabs from 11 to 7. Import VAT is 13% on value plus duty. SAARC preferential rate may apply with a certificate of origin. | Clearing agent fee unknown | ⚠ | https://www.customsnepal.com/faq; get a clearing agent’s written quote |

Standard order terms to adopt (draft, not legal advice)

- Quote valid 7 days. Work starts on a **50% deposit** and written artwork approval.
- Customer is responsible for spelling, logo rights and colour approval on the signed proof.
- Deposit is non-refundable once plates or dies are made.
- Printed quantities may vary ±10%. Faults caused by us are re-made or credited. Customer-approved proofs are not grounds for rejection.
- Balance due before delivery for new accounts, net 15 days for repeat accounts.
- Minimum order value or minimum contribution rule (see `07_product_pricing_model.csv`).
- Cancelled custom orders are charged for completed work and materials.

Next steps (ordered)

1. Meet a Nepal CA this week. Ask about business form, the registration route, goods vs mixed VAT classification, and total registration cost.
2. Register and obtain a PAN before the first invoice.
3. Add written supplier food-grade confirmation to the supplier checklist before any bakery/takeaway order.

Supplier Quotation Requests (ready to send)

Status as of 2026-10-23: **no request has been sent and no quotation received.** Replace the bracketed fields. Send the same specification to at least 3 suppliers per product so prices can be compared. Record answers in `07_product_pricing_model.csv` and the Assumptions sheet of `08_financial_model.xlsx`.

A. RFQ to packaging manufacturers / printers (Nepal)

Subject: Quotation request: custom printed packaging for [Business name], Kathmandu

Namaste,

We are a packaging design and supply start-up in [location]. Please quote for the items below, delivered to [address] in Kathmandu Valley.

#	Product	Exact size (L×W×H mm)	Material / thickness	Printing	Finish	Quantities to quote
1	Kraft paper bag with twisted handle	[e.g. 250×120×320]	[kraft ___ gsm]	1 colour logo	none	100 / 250 / 500 / 1,000 / 5,000
2	Folding carton	[e.g. 90×90×120]	[350 gsm art board]	4-colour	matt lamination	100 / 250 / 500 / 1,000 / 5,000
3	Mailer box (corrugated, E-flute)	[e.g. 300×200×80]	[___ ply]	1–2 colour	none	100 / 250 / 500 / 1,000 / 5,000
4	Bakery/takeaway box	[e.g. 2 lb cake box]	[corrugated, food-grade liner?]	1–2 colour	none	100 / 250 / 500 / 1,000 / 5,000
5	Rigid gift box	[e.g. 200×150×60]	[grey board + wrap paper]	1 colour + [foil?]	[lamination/foil]	50 / 100 / 250 / 500 / 1,000
6	Sticker / label, round 50 mm	50 mm	[vinyl/paper, matt]	4-colour	kiss-cut	100 / 250 / 500 / 1,000 / 5,000

Please state for every line: 1. Unit price at each quantity, and the minimum order quantity. 2. One-off charges: design/artwork, printing plates or blocks, cutting die, set-up. Say whether the die and plates are reusable and who owns them. 3. Sample or prototype: cost, and time to make a white sample and a printed sample. 4. Production lead time after artwork approval, and for repeat orders. 5. Delivery to Kathmandu Valley: charge and time. 6. Tax: are prices inclusive or exclusive of 13% VAT? Will you issue a VAT or PAN bill? 7. Payment terms: deposit %, balance terms, credit for repeat orders. 8. Artwork file format required, and colour-matching tolerance. 9. Rejection and replacement policy for faulty or misprinted goods. 10. Whether you make the goods yourself or outsource any step, and which. 11. Food-contact suitability of the board, ink and coating for item 4, if any. 12. Validity of this quotation (date).

Please reply by [date]. Thank you. [Name, phone, WhatsApp]

B. RFQ to machinery sellers (use only after the pilot gate)

Subject: Quotation: [machine type], delivered and installed in Kathmandu

Please quote for [make and model]: new or used, price in [INR/NPR], whether GST or VAT is included, freight to Kathmandu, **customs and import-tax treatment for Nepal**, installation and training, required voltage and power load, consumables (blades, mats, ink) with prices, rated and practical throughput on [material], supported materials, warranty terms, service availability in Nepal, spare-parts lead time, and 2 references from existing Nepal customers.

C. Quote to a customs agent / clearing house (Kathmandu / Birgunj)

Please advise the Nepal customs classification (HS code), duty, VAT and any other charges on [machine, value, origin], plus clearing and transport costs to Kathmandu, and the documents required.

D. Customer-facing quotation template (for later)

Quotation No. / Date / Valid until: Customer / Contact: Item, size, material, print, finish: Quantity | Unit price | Line total Design fee | Die/plate/set-up fee | Sample fee (credited against the order) Delivery Subtotal; VAT (if registered); **Total** Terms: 50% deposit to start, balance before delivery (or net 15 days for repeat accounts); artwork approval required in writing; lead time [x working days] from approval; ±10% quantity tolerance on printed goods; minimum order value NPR [__].

Appendix: Competitor database

Source file: `03_competitor_database.csv` (full columns in the Excel pack).

business_name	location	product_categories	minimum_order	prices	verification_status
The Box House Nepal	Gathaghar, Ward 3, Madhyapur Thimi, Bhaktapur	Corrugated pizza, cake, pastry, burger, e-commerce boxes (search snippet)	10in pizza box sold in packs of 50; custom MOQ not publicly disclosed / not found	Listed sale prices: pastry box NPR 10 (was 18); 2lb cake box NPR 35 (was 45); 10in pizza box x50 NPR 1,249; 12in pizza box NPR 20 (unit not stated)	Page fetched; prices verified; other fields snippet-only
Atlas Packaging Pvt Ltd	Gairidhara, Kathmandu (per search snippet)	Custom designed, colour-printed cake boxes for bakeries	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Search snippet only; page not fetched
Print House Nepal	Kathmandu (per snippet)	Packaging & Label Studio: custom boxes and labels (snippet)	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Snippet only; site down at fetch
Nepal Can Packaging	Unknown	Custom boxes, wholesale packaging supplies, custom-printed courier bags (snippet)	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Fetch returned title only; details snippet-only
Global Packaging Industries	Mahalaxmi, Kathmandu (directory listing)	Shipping & mailer packaging boxes (directory)	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Third-party directory only
Shree Ganapati Box Industries	Jadibuti, Kathmandu	Cardboard / carton boxes	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Snippet only
Chandika Print Pack	Kathmandu	Flexible plastic packaging (biscuit packets) - large printer	Industrial MOQs (inference)	not publicly disclosed / not found	Secondary source (college visit page)
API Printing Press	Bagbazar, Kathmandu	Business cards, brochures, flyers, flex, ID cards, stamps, T-shirt/mug printing	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Directory listing only
Nepali Paper Products (P) Ltd	Ring Road, Kathmandu (PaperIndex)	Handmade/Lokta paper, gift bags, gift boxes	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Directory listing only
Mahaguthi	Kathmandu	Gift bags, silk-paper boxes, round/oval boxes (listing)	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Directory listing only
Shubham Handicrafts	Kuleshwor, Kathmandu	Lokta paper products incl. paper bags	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Directory listing only
Himalayan Paper Works	Bhaktapur	Lokta stationery, gift bags & boxes (listing)	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Search-summary only; URL not retained
Step Design Printways (India)	India (IndiaMART)	Rigid, magnetic, jewellery, cosmetic boxes; says Nepal is a major market (snippet)	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Snippet only

business_name	location	product_categories	minimum_order	prices	verification_status
S. R. Art Printers (India)	India (IndiaMART)	Digital and die-cut sticker printing	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Snippet only
Prime Felt and Agro Industries Pvt Ltd (PFA)	GPO Box 3262, Kathmandu	Custom packaging: cotton drawstring bags, cardboard/hard-paper boxes, paper and Lokta bags, jars; private label, white label, ODM	May apply MOQ (no figure)	not publicly disclosed / not found	Page fetched (V)
Packaging Product	Lazimpat, P.O. Box 4247, Kathmandu	Custom packaging and design services (directory)	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Directory listing (S)
Chandrama Packaging	Unknown (Facebook)	Boxes for restaurants and bakeries (snippet)	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Snippet only (S)
Infinity Print Nepal	Kathmandu branches (TikTok)	Custom gift boxes (snippet)	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Snippet only (S)
Himalayan Everest Paper Packaging Pvt Ltd	Chhauni, Kathmandu	Paper packaging (name)	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Directory listing (S)
Ace Packaging Pvt Ltd	Jwagal, Lalitpur	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Directory listing (S)
Modern Packaging Industry	Balaju, Kathmandu	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	not publicly disclosed / not found	Directory listing (S)
Printo (India)	India (online)	Mailers, mono cartons, rigid boxes, sticker-embellished mailers	FAQ: 100 for custom mailers; listings from 1-50	Flat mailer ₹30@10; 1-colour mailer ₹33@50; mono carton ₹33@10; rigid top&bottom ₹247@100; magnetic rigid ₹317@100; multicolour mailer ₹79@500	Page fetched (V)
EzPac (India)	India (online)	Custom boxes, mailers from 10 units	10 units	₹80-200 (10-25); ₹50-120 (50-100); ₹30-80 (200-500); ₹20-50 (500+)	Blog fetched (V)
Diva Design (India)	Ahmedabad	Stickers, labels, small-batch packaging	No minimum (claim)	not publicly disclosed / not found	Snippet only (S)

Appendix: Customer segments and channel partners

Source file: `04_customer_prospect_database.csv` (full columns in the Excel pack).

record_type	segment	typical_packaging	likely_order_value_npr_assumed	priority_score_1to5	notes
SEGMENT	Bakeries, cake shops, dessert brands	Printed cake/pastry/takeaway boxes, bags	18,000-35,000	4.5	Most visible local demand evidence (Atlas supplies Valley bakeries per snippet)
SEGMENT	Cafes, restaurants, cloud kitchens	Takeaway boxes, cups sleeves, bags, stickers	12,000-30,000	3.5	Price-driven; food-contact compliance
SEGMENT	Skincare / soap / candle / personal-care brands	Folding cartons, labels, rigid boxes	25,000-60,000	5	Best margin fit; design-led; small MOQs wanted (hypothesis to test)
SEGMENT	Boutiques / clothing / accessories / jewellery	Paper bags, small gift boxes, tags, stickers	15,000-40,000	4	Branded bags are a repeat item
SEGMENT	E-commerce & social-commerce sellers	Mailer boxes, courier bags, stickers	10,000-30,000	3.5	Many micro-sellers; low AOV
SEGMENT	Tea / coffee / spice / dry-food brands	Pouches (outsourced), labels, cartons, gift boxes	20,000-60,000	3.5	Food-contact and labelling rules apply
SEGMENT	Corporate gifting / event planners / florists	Rigid boxes, bags, custom kits	40,000-150,000	4	Large tickets, seasonal, tighter deadlines
SEGMENT	Handicraft producers / exporters / hotels	Gift boxes, bags, labels	20,000-80,000	3	Competes with handmade-paper suppliers
SEGMENT	Pharma / medical	Regulated cartons/labels	-	1	Postpone - compliance burden
NOTE	ALL segments				No named prospect is listed because none was verified in this session (search tool returned no business-level directory). Build the 150+ prospect list from Google Maps/Instagram in days 1-7 using the protocol in 10_90_day_action_plan.md. Do not mark any prospect contacted until contacted.
CHANNEL_PARTNER	E-commerce merchants via Nepal Can Move (Nepalcan.com)	Mailers, courier bags, stickers	9,500 (T1 kit)	5	Pitch co-branded ship-ready packaging offer; 5% commission. Not contacted.
CHANNEL_PARTNER	E-commerce merchants via Pathao Commerce	Mailers, stickers	9,500 (T1 kit)	5	Same as above. Not contacted.

Appendix: Machinery and supplier database

Source file: `05_machinery_and_supplier_database.csv` (full columns in the Excel pack).

record_type	category	item_or_supplier	supplier_country	advertised_price	original_currency	est_landed_npr_placeholder_25pct	recommendation	confidence
MACHINE	Cutting plotter	Roland GS2-24 (listing)	India (IndiaMART listing)	119000	INR	238223	Not recommended before pilot gate	Low
MACHINE	Cutting plotter	Radium cutting plotter (Om Trading, New Delhi)	India (IndiaMART listing)	127000	INR	254238	Not recommended before pilot gate	Low
MACHINE	Label cutter	Sticker half-cutter (Delhi-NCR seller)	India (IndiaMART listing)	115000	INR	230216	Not recommended before pilot gate	Low
MACHINE	Label cutter	Servo-motor label cutter	India (IndiaMART listing)	190000	INR	380356	Not recommended before pilot gate	Low
MACHINE	Die cutter	Sticker cutting machine (C Press, Chennai)	India (IndiaMART listing)	150000	INR	300281	Not recommended before pilot gate	Low
MACHINE	Digital half-cutter	Digital sticker half-cutting machine (C Press)	India (IndiaMART listing)	450000	INR	900844	Not recommended before pilot gate	Low
MACHINE	Wide-format printer	Epson T3130n 24in (Bengaluru, used)	India (IndiaMART listing)	95000	INR	190178	Not recommended before pilot gate	Low
MACHINE	Wide-format printer	HP DesignJet Z6dr 44in	India (IndiaMART listing)	285000	INR	570534	Not recommended before pilot gate	Low
SUPPLIER_CANDIDATE	Corrugated/printed boxes	The Box House Nepal	Nepal (Bhaktapur)		NPR		Candidate outsourcing partner	Low
SUPPLIER_CANDIDATE	Bakery boxes	Atlas Packaging Pvt Ltd	Nepal (Kathmandu)		NPR		Candidate outsourcing partner	Low
SUPPLIER_CANDIDATE	Shipping/mailer boxes	Global Packaging Industries	Nepal (Kathmandu)		NPR		Candidate	Low
SUPPLIER_CANDIDATE	Rigid boxes (backup, import)	Step Design Printways	India		INR		Backup for rigid boxes	Low
SUPPLIER_CANDIDATE	Handmade gift bags/boxes	Nepali Paper Products / Mahaguthi	Nepal (Kathmandu)		NPR		Premium handmade niche	Low

record_type	category	item_or_supplier	supplier_country	advertised_price	original_currency	est_landed_npr_placeholder_25pct	recommendation	confidence
MACHINE	Colour label printer	Epson ColorWorks C4050 (4in)	India (IndiaMART: Bar Tech System, New Delhi ₹1,52,500; Global Tek, Mumbai ₹1,53,000)	152500	INR	318755	Do NOT buy: payback ~31 years at strategy volume (15_strategy_model Label_Printer_BE)	Low
SUPPLIER_CANDIDATE	Short-run digital cartons/mailers (T2, pooled import)	Printo	India	33	INR	90 (consolidated, unverified duty)	T2 supplier candidate	Medium
SUPPLIER_CANDIDATE	Short-run custom packaging (T2)	EzPac	India	20-200 by qty	INR		T2 supplier candidate	Medium
SUPPLIER_CANDIDATE	Kraft bags (benchmark)	Mahalaxmi Enterprise (TradeIndia)	India	15	INR	45 (consolidated)	Benchmark only - Nepal cheaper	Low
SUPPLIER_CANDIDATE	Stock boxes for T1 kits	The Box House Nepal	Nepal	10-35	NPR		T1 stock supplier candidate	Medium

Appendix: Product pricing model (assumptions)

Source file: `07_product_pricing_model.csv` (full columns in the Excel pack).

product	qty	supplier_unit_cost_npr	unit_price_npr	revenue_ex_vat_npr	gross_margin	contribution_npr	meets_3000_min_contribution
1 Kraft paper bag, 1-colour logo	100	45	68	9675	0	395	NO
1 Kraft paper bag, 1-colour logo	250	34	52	15875	0	2382	NO
1 Kraft paper bag, 1-colour logo	500	28	42	23875	0	4597	YES
1 Kraft paper bag, 1-colour logo	1000	23	34	36875	0	8132	YES
1 Kraft paper bag, 1-colour logo	5000	19	28	142875	0	38382	YES
2 Folding carton, 4-colour	100	95	150	28350	0	4940	YES
2 Folding carton, 4-colour	250	62	96	37350	0	7625	YES
2 Folding carton, 4-colour	500	42	64	45350	0	9840	YES
2 Folding carton, 4-colour	1000	30	46	59350	0	14360	YES
2 Folding carton, 4-colour	5000	20	31	168350	0	49625	YES
3 Printed corrugated mailer box	100	85	125	18600	0	2866	NO
3 Printed corrugated mailer box	250	64	95	29850	0	6222	YES
3 Printed corrugated mailer box	500	50	74	43100	0	10004	YES
3 Printed corrugated mailer box	1000	40	58	64100	0	15238	YES
3 Printed corrugated mailer box	5000	32	46	236100	0	61058	YES
4 Sticker/label 50mm kiss-cut	100	9	15	2075	0	-583	NO
4 Sticker/label 50mm kiss-cut	250	6.5	11	3325	0	-99	NO
4 Sticker/label 50mm kiss-cut	500	5	8.5	4825	0	478	NO

product	qty	supplier_unit_cost_npr	unit_price_npr	revenue_ex_vat_npr	gross_margin	contribution_npr	meets_3000_min_contribution
4 Sticker/label 50mm kiss-cut	1000	3.8	6.5	7075	0	1355	NO
4 Sticker/label 50mm kiss-cut	5000	2.4	4	20575	0	6206	YES
5 Rigid gift box	50	420	620	42050	0	7989	YES
5 Rigid gift box	100	350	520	63050	0	14254	YES
5 Rigid gift box	250	290	430	118550	0	30297	YES
5 Rigid gift box	500	250	370	196050	0	52559	YES
5 Rigid gift box	1000	215	320	331050	0	92834	YES
6 Bakery/takeaway box, printed	100	38	58	12550	0	1348	NO
6 Bakery/takeaway box, printed	250	30	45	18000	0	2905	NO
6 Bakery/takeaway box, printed	500	24	36	24750	0	4919	YES
6 Bakery/takeaway box, printed	1000	19	28	34750	0	7559	YES
6 Bakery/takeaway box, printed	5000	15	21	111750	0	25724	YES

Appendix: Sources and evidence register

Source file: `11_sources_and_evidence_register.csv` (full columns in the Excel pack).

Claim_ID	Claim	Value	Unit	Source_URL	Confidence	Verification_Status
E01	NRB USD selling rate	155.08	NPR/USD	https://www.sharesansar.com/newsdetail/nrb-publishes-mondays-forex-rates-us-dollar-fixed-at-rs-15508-2026-10-12	High	Verified via search result
E02	NRB INR selling rate (per 100 INR)	160.15	NPR/100 INR	same as E01	High	Verified via search result
E03	VAT registration threshold - goods	5000000	NPR/yr	https://udhamsathi.com/blog/vat-registration-nepal	Medium	Needs IRD confirmation
E04	VAT registration threshold - services/mixed	3000000	NPR/yr	same as E03	Medium	Needs IRD confirmation
E05	VAT standard rate	13	%	same as E03	Medium	Needs IRD confirmation
E06	PAN required before VAT registration	yes	-	same as E03	Medium	Needs IRD confirmation
E07	Ban on plastic bags below 40 microns in force by Gazette notice (Environment Protection Act 2019 s.15); fine up to NPR 300,000	40	micron	https://thehimalayantimes.com/nepal/ban-on-plastic-bags-below-40-micron-comes-into-effect-nationwide	Medium	Verify current status with MoFE/municipality
E08	Box House Nepal pastry box price	10	NPR	https://boxhousenepal.com.np/	Medium	Directly fetched
E09	Box House Nepal 2lb cake box price	35	NPR	same	Medium	Directly fetched
E10	Box House Nepal 10in pizza box x50	1249	NPR/pack of 50	same	Medium	Directly fetched
E11	Box House Nepal 12in pizza box	20	NPR	same	Medium	Directly fetched
E12	Roland GS2-24 cutting plotter advertised	119000	INR	https://m.indiamart.com/proddetail/digital-plotter-printer-15957722430.html	Low	Not page-verified
E13	Radium cutting plotter advertised	127000	INR	https://m.indiamart.com/proddetail/plotter-printer-20127469462.html	Low	Snippet only

Claim_ID	Claim	Value	Unit	Source_URL	Confidence	Verification_Status
E14	Sticker cutting machine advertised (C Press)	150000	INR	https://m.indiamart.com/cpress-chennai/die-cutting-machine.html	Low	Snippet only
E15	Digital sticker half-cutter advertised (C Press)	450000	INR	same	Low	Snippet only
E16	Sticker half-cutter / servo label cutter advertised	115000 / 190000	INR	https://m.indiamart.com/digitalprint-solutions/label-cutters.html	Low	Snippet only
E17	Used Epson T3130n plotter advertised	95000	INR	IndiaMART via search	Low	Snippet only
E18	India is main paper-bag supplier to Nepal (2023); volumes masked	qualitative	-	https://indexbox.co.uk/store/nepal-sacks-and-bags-of-paper-market-analysis-forecast-size-trends-and-insights/	Low	No market size obtained
E19	Atlas Packaging supplies custom printed cake boxes to Valley bakeries	qualitative	-	https://www.facebook.com/atlaspackagingpvtltd/	Low	Snippet only
E20	All supplier costs, selling prices, order value, reorder rate, funnel, opex	see workbook	NPR	08_financial_model.xlsx Assumptions	Low	UNVERIFIED - must be replaced by quotes
E21	No verified Kathmandu sticker/label printer, rigid-box specialist or paper-bag printing factory found by search	absence of evidence	-	web searches 2026-10-23	Low	Field survey needed
E22	Printo flat mailer ₹30@10; 1-colour mailer ₹33@50; mono carton ₹33@10; rigid ₹247@100; magnetic rigid ₹317@100; multicolour mailer ₹79@500; standard TAT 20-25 business days	see claim	INR/unit	https://printo.in/categories/shipping-and-flat-mailer-boxes	Medium	Directly fetched

Claim_ID	Claim	Value	Unit	Source_URL	Confidence	Verification_Status
E23	EzPac price bands ₹80-200 (10-25), ₹50-120 (50-100), ₹30-80 (200-500), ₹20-50 (500+); MOQ 10	see claim	INR/unit	https://ezpac.in/blogs/news/custom-packaging-small-business-india	Medium	Directly fetched
E24	Indian guide: corrugated die setup ₹2,000-8,000; rigid setup ₹5,000-15,000, ₹80-300/unit, MOQ ~1,000; labels ₹1-10; digital 50-100 units; off-peak Jan-Mar	see claim	INR	https://www.onlineprintout.in/guides/packaging-printing-for-small-business/	Medium	Directly fetched
E25	Logo kraft bag ₹15/piece MOQ 500 (Mahalaxmi, Bhiwandi); ₹8.50 MOQ 500 (Kolkata)	8.5-15	INR/piece	https://www.tradeindia.com/products/paper-gift-bag-c11491287.html	Low	Search snippet
E26	3PL delivery in Kathmandu Rs70-80 per delivery (down from Rs200-300); Nepal Can Move 1,000+ merchants; Pathao Commerce 600+ merchants in 2 weeks; >90% online merchants in Valley; 1,530 applied / 345 approved e-commerce registrations	see claim	-	https://kathmandupost.com/money/2026/08/27/fast-delivery-changes-the-game-for-nepal-s-online-sellers	Medium	Directly fetched
E27	E-commerce Act 2025: online sellers incl. Facebook/Instagram/TikTok/WhatsApp must register; 950 registered by 18 Jul 2025 deadline; fines up to Rs200,000	see claim	-	https://kathmandupost.com/money/2025/07/20/unregistered-online-sellers-now-illegal-in-nepal-under-new-e-commerce-law	Medium	Search snippet
E28	Prime Felt & Agro: in-house design + manufacturing partner + private label; MOQ may apply; phone +977 982-385-7547	qualitative	-	https://www.pfa.com.np/services/custom-packaging	Medium	Directly fetched

Claim_ID	Claim	Value	Unit	Source_URL	Confidence	Verification_Status
E29	nepalyp lists 70 ‘packaging solutions’ entries in Kathmandu (incl. non-packaging firms); page 1 includes Packaging Product (Lazimpat, custom packaging & design)	70	listings	https://www.nepalyp.com/category/Packaging_solutions/city:Kathmandu	Low	Directly fetched
E30	Budget 2083/84 cut customs slabs from 11 to 7; rates cut on 273 items; excise removed on 360 items	qualitative	-	https://thehimalayantimes.com/business/govt-cuts-customs-tariff-slabs-scraps-excise-duty-on-360-items	Medium	Search snippet
E31	Epson ColorWorks C4050 listed ₹1,52,500 (New Delhi) / ₹1,53,000 (Mumbai)	152500	INR	https://m.indiamart.com/global-tek/epson-colour-label-printer-c-3510-c-4050-c-6550a.html	Low	Search snippet
E32	Valley establishments 2018 Economic Census: Kathmandu 123,994; Lalitpur 27,009; Bhaktapur 19,629	170632	establishments	https://www.stat.go.jp/info/meetings/nepal/pdf/nec2018analysis.pdf	Medium	Search snippet
E33	Strategy-model landed cost inputs: India GST 12%, freight 8%, Nepal duty 15%, fixed NPR 7,000/shipment	see claim	ratio	15_strategy_model.xlsx Inputs	Low	UNVERIFIED - get clearing-agent quote